The desire to live is natural. It is in me also. I do not want to conceal it. But it is conditional. I do not want to live as a prisoner or under restrictions . . . Yet, one thing pricks me even today. My heart nurtured some ambitions for doing something for humanity and for my country. I have not been able to fulfil even one-thousandth part of these ambitions. If I live I might perhaps get a chance to fulfil them. If ever it came to my mind that I should not die, it came from this end only.[1]

An excerpt from Bhagat Singh's last letter to the convicts of the Lahore Conspiracy Case, dated 22 March 1931, the day before his execution.

I am, after all, a human being

and nothing more.

And no one can claim to be

more than that.

(Bhagat Singh, 'Why I Am an Atheist', 1931)